

Urban & Rural Development in Bangladesh



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Objectives of the Class

- ❑ Define the concept of urbanization' and evaluate the development trend of it in both national and international perspective.
- ❑ Find out the causes of urbanization in Bangladesh and scratch out the reasons for migration.
- ❑ Explore the impact or consequences of urbanization in Bangladesh.
- ❑ Reveal some challenges and problems which are available in urban area of Bangladesh and how to meet these challenges.
- ❑ Define the concept of rural development and evaluate the development trend of it in BD.
- ❑ Identify the rural development model e.g. BARD and evaluate the role of government and NGOs
- ❑ Reveal some challenges and problems available in rural area of Bangladesh and how to meet these challenges.

Urbanization: The Concept

- ❑ Urbanization means the concentration of people in cities and towns. Urbanization refers to the number of people who migrate from rural areas to urban areas, resulting in growth.
- ❑ It describes the transition of *rural* conditions (farms and small towns) to *urban* conditions (cities).
- ❑ It is the process where increasing percentage of a population lives in cities and suburbs.



Urbanization: The Concept

- ❑ The social work dictionary simplifies *Urbanization* as a 'social trend in which people adopt the life styles, residential patterns and cultural values of those who live in or near cities.'
- ❑ According to Cambridge dictionary, *Urbanization* is the process by which more and more people leave the countryside to live in cities.

Urbanization: Development Trend

- Today, some 56% of the world's population – 4.4 billion inhabitants – live in cities. This trend is expected to continue, with the urban population more than doubling its current size by 2050, at which point nearly 7 of 10 people will live in cities. (**Source:** World Bank Group, 2023).
- Today, the most urbanized regions include Northern America (with 82% of its population living in urban areas in 2018), Latin America and the Caribbean (81%), Europe (74%) and Oceania (68%). The level of urbanization in Asia is now approximating 50%. In contrast, Africa remains mostly rural, with 43% of its population living in urban areas.
- Africa and Asia are urbanizing faster than the other regions and are projected to **become 56 and 64 per cent urban, respectively, by 2050.** (**Source:** Population Division of the UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs (UN DESA), 2018)

Urbanization: Development Trend

- The urban population of the world has grown rapidly since 1950, from 751 million to 4.2 billion in 2018.
- Asia, despite its relatively lower level of urbanization, is home to 54% of the world's urban population, followed by Europe and Africa with 13% each.
- Continuing population growth and urbanization are projected to add 2.5 billion people to the world's urban population by 2050, with nearly 90 per cent of the increase concentrated in Asia and Africa.

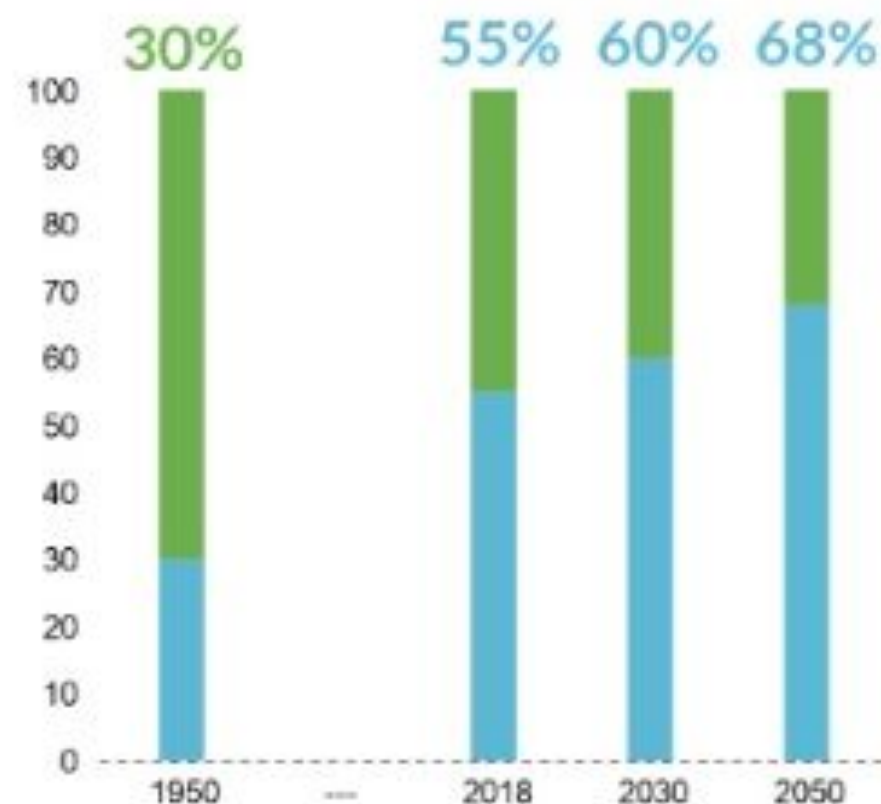
Source: UN DESA, 2018

Urbanization: Development Trend

World Urbanization Prospects 2018 - Our future is urban

Our future is urban!

From only **751 million** in 1950, the population of the world's cities has rocketed to **4.2 billion**.



World Urbanization Prospects: The 2018 Revision

Access the report: bit.ly/wup2018 • #UNPopulation



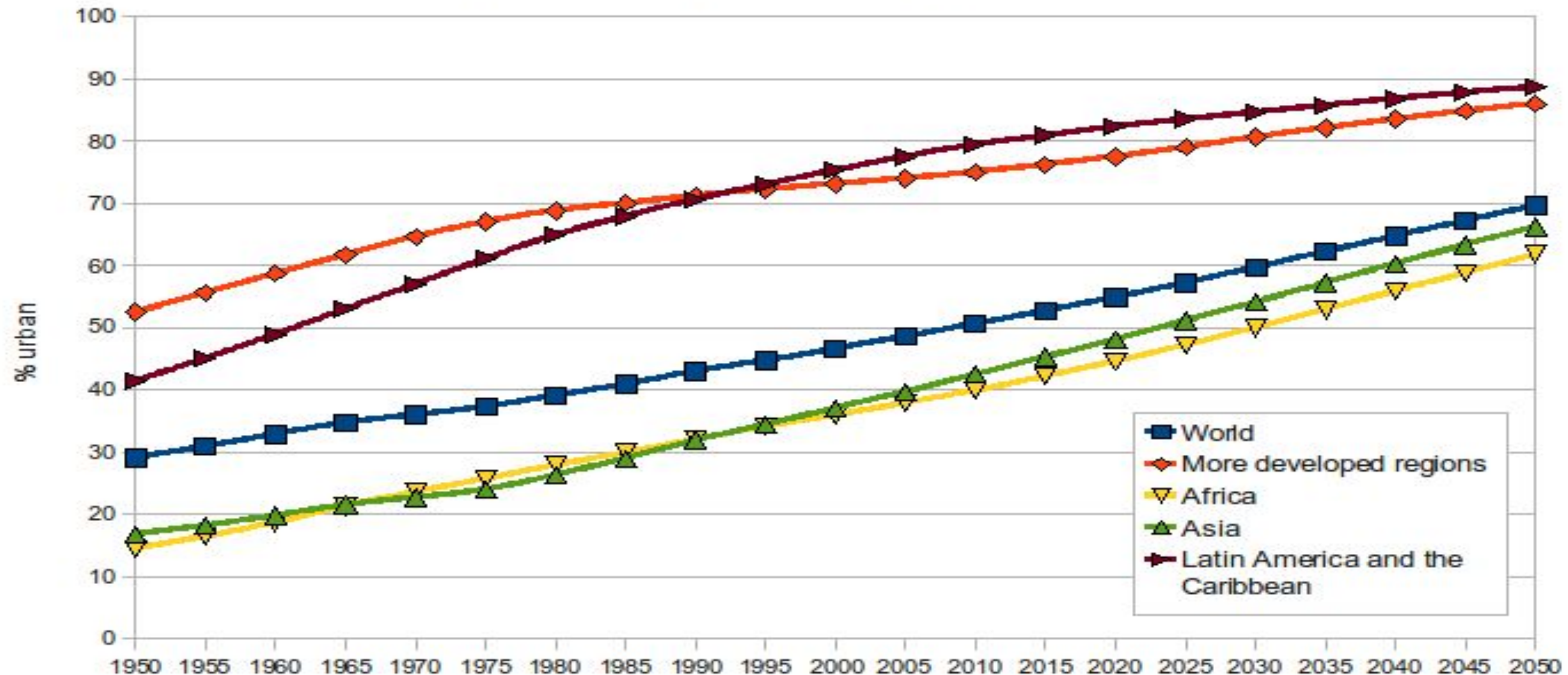
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Urbanization: Development Trend

International Perspective : Urbanization Prospects

Percentage of Population Living in Urban Areas by Region, 1950-2050.

Source: UN World Urbanization Prospects, 2007.

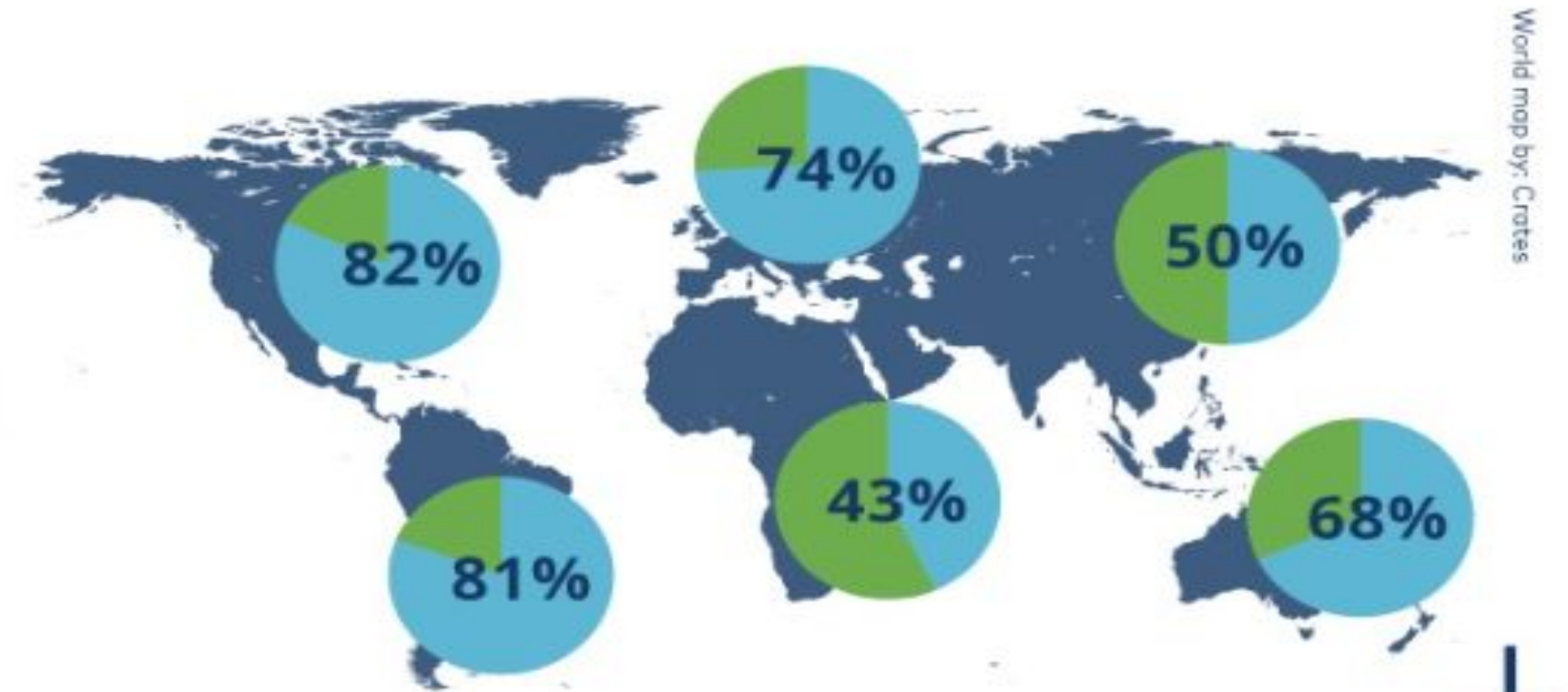


Urbanization: Development Trend

World Urbanization Prospects 2018 - Urbanization around the world

Urbanization around the world

The Americas are the most urbanized regions in the world today.



World Urbanization Prospects: The 2018 Revision

Access the report: bit.ly/wup2018 • #UNPopulation

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UN DESA

Source: World Urbanization Prospects 2018 by UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs

Rural Development : Global Scenario

- The rural population of the world has grown slowly since 1950 and is expected to reach its peak in a few years. **The global rural population is now close to 3.4 billion and is expected to decline to 3.2 billion by 2050.**
- Africa and Asia are home to nearly 90 per cent of the world's rural population. India has the largest rural population (857 million), followed by China (635 million).

Source: World Urbanization Trends 2014: Key Facts

Urbanization: Development Trend

Bangladesh Perspective

- ❑ With over 180 million people Bangladesh is the world's eighth most populous country and also one of the densest. **The population of the country, by 2060, might be 230 million, with more than 70 percent being urban.**
- ❑ **As per recent UN data, 25 percent of Bangladesh current population lives in urban areas.** Of this urban population, more than half lives in the largest four cities: Dhaka, Chittagong, Khulna and Rajshahi. Dhaka mega city currently ranks as the world's 11th largest city .

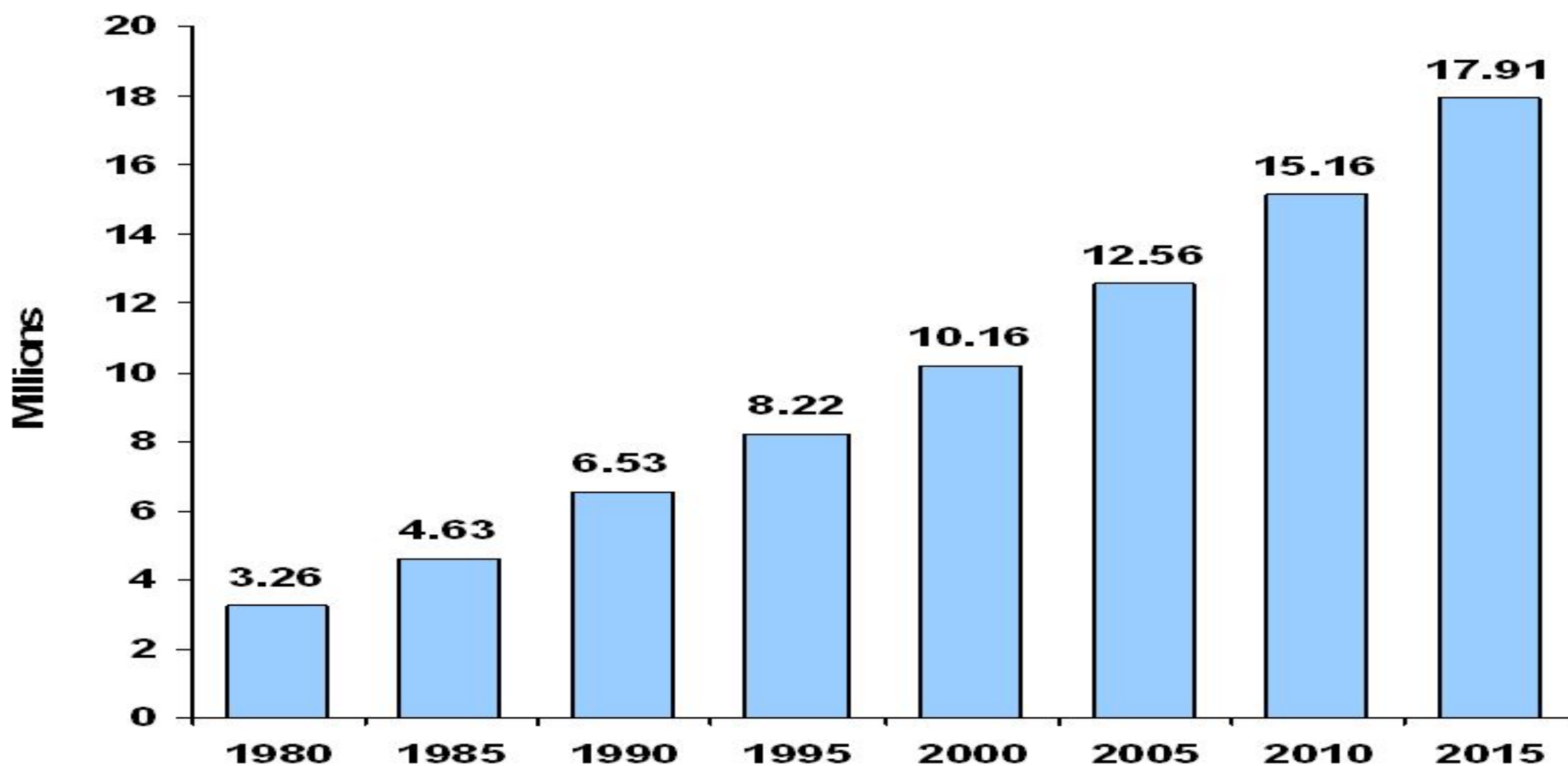
Urbanization: Development Trend

Bangladesh Perspective

- ❑ The World Bank says Dhaka, with its current population of 15 million people, bears the distinction of being the fastest-growing in the world. Between 1990 and 2005, the city doubled in size — from 6 to 12 million. By 2025, the U.N. predicts Dhaka will be home to more than 20 million people.
- ❑ The total urban area of Dhaka spans about 1530 square kilometers (Islam 2005). About 80% of the garments industry in Bangladesh is located in Dhaka city (World Bank 2005). Dhaka city contributes to about 13% of the country's GDP.



Population Growth of Dhaka Megacity 1980-2015



Rural-Urban Migration: Push-Pull model

- ❑ The Push-Pull model pioneered was by Everett S. Lee in 1996. Migration is the combined effect of both push and pulls factors and it is often difficult to separate the role of the two.

Push factors may be identified for Bangladesh as:

1. Population pressure, adverse person-land ratio, landlessness and poverty.
2. Frequent and severe natural disasters (particularly river bank erosion).
3. Law and order situation.
4. Lack of social and cultural opportunities (applicable for rural rich)
5. Cyclone, famine, flood, river erosion.

Rural-Urban Migration: Push-Pull model

The pull factors may be identified for Bangladesh as:

1. Real or perceived job Opportunities and
2. Higher wages in the city are the main pulls.
3. Rural-urban disparities, opportunities and services are also responsible.
4. Rural-urban migrations are due to marriage and other familial reasons.
5. Educational facilities pull rural people to the cities

Causes of Rural-Urban Migration

ECONOMIC	ENVIRONMENTAL	FAMILY	SOCIO POLITICAL
Landless and poverty	Natural Hazards	Loses of husband	Social Factors
Unemployment/t Poverty	Mostly river bank erosion	Dissolution of family	Brought by relative
Economic crisis		Dependents	Village politics
Lack of Job opportunities			Communal riot

Impact of Migration and Urbanization (Positive)

According to UN centre for human settlements, 50 percent of GNP comes from urban areas in the developing countries. Some positive consequences of urbanization in Bangladesh are:

1. **Economic benefits:** growth of GDP, higher productivity, better income etc.
2. **Socio-cultural benefits:** modernization
3. **Political benefits:** Women empowerment, democracy etc.
4. Improved access to information technology.
5. **Infrastructural development benefits:** Improvement of communication and transportation
6. **Socio-economic development:** Employment opportunities, Increase literacy rate, improvement in the quality of education, and better health indicators.

Impact of Migration and Urbanization (Negative)

Urbanization is not an unmixed blessing. Its negative consequences are of great concern. The negative consequences can be grouped as the following:

1. Rapid growth of urbanization on a massive scale degrades the urban environment.
2. Environmental consequences: pollution
3. Encroachment on productive agricultural land and forests
4. Extreme pressure on housing, growth of slums and the pressure on services
5. Economic consequences, leading to income inequality and poverty, ill effects of globalization
7. Cultural consequences: entry of alien culture, loss of national cultural identity
8. Political consequences: Criminalization of politics.
9. Socio-economic problems: High density of population, House and slum problems, Scarcity of utility services, Social discrimination & inequality, Terrorism and crime.

Major Problems in Urban Area

Urbanization is the movement of people from a rural to an urban area. During the Industrial Revolution, people began moving into the cities to work in the factories and industries that would change or eliminate their previous jobs in rural communities. While this helped cities to grow exponentially, it brought with it a number of social problems and conflicts. Such as,

1. Transport problem
2. Climate change
3. Unplanned urbanization
4. Water logging
5. Environment pollution
6. River pollution
7. Air pollution
8. **Imbalanced administrative development**
9. Over population Problem

River Pollution

Most industrial enterprises are dumping their toxic effluents into neighboring water bodies and rivers. The erroneous, Cordon Approach towards rivers, pursued for decades under foreign advice, is disrupting the rivers. Buriganga river, which flows by Dhaka, is now one of the most polluted rivers in Bangladesh because of rampant dumping of industrial and human waste.



Water logging

Dhaka, the capital city of Bangladesh, is an example of unplanned urbanisation. Every year the city dwellers of Dhaka face extensive water-logging during the monsoon. Water-logging is not a new problem rather it is one of the old problems of the capital.



Air pollution

Unfit traffic, industries, dust, particles of paints and wood are extremely high in Dhaka city what causes uncountable air pollution. Childs and women are highly vulnerable in this pollution. For example, Air pollution in capital city Dhaka has gone higher than Mexico City. According to the Department of Environment, the density of airborne particulate matter reaches **463** micrograms per cubic meter.



Imbalanced administrative development

The Dhaka-centric development has resulted in relative Neglect of divisional, district and *upazilla* cities and towns. The country faces a vicious circle, whereby lack of development in district and *upazilla* towns is causing their affluent residents to flock to Dhaka.



Transport problem

Over the last few years the transportation problem of Dhaka City has visibly been deteriorating steadily. Citizens constantly complain about the unbearable twin problems of traffic jam and air pollution. Narrow roads, broken roads and unplanned repairs appeared as the 3 main causes of traffic jam.



Unplanned urbanisation

An unplanned urbanization across the country leads to discrimination between the capital Dhaka and other metropolitan cities and district towns. Unplanned growth of cities is increasing the risks of fire hazard, building collapse, water logging, drainage congestion and road accidents.



Overpopulation problem

Bangladesh has the highest density of population. Some problems associated with overpopulation are shortage of food, inadequate fresh water, crowding, traffic, unemployment, high crime rates. Dhaka has grown so crowded that existing infrastructure make it impossible to lead a comfortable life. Titled "World Urbanization Prospects: The 2014 Revision", the UN report projected Dhaka would become the 6th most crowded city by 2030 with a population of over 2.7 crore.



Meeting the Challenges (1)

Urbanization is a compelling and growing reality. Managed or ignored, the process will soon come to determine our economic prospects and the quality of our social lives. So we have to meet the challenges by following steps:

1. Decentralization
2. Rural Entrepreneurship
3. Ensuring the lodging for the urbanized people
4. Enhancement of opportunities
5. Focus on good governance
6. Improving City Governance: the Principal Strategy

Source: Overview of Urbanization in Bangladesh by
Nazrul Islam, Chairman, (CUS), Dhaka

Meeting the Challenges (2)

7. Decentralization of Functions and Responsibilities

8. Good Urban Planning and Sound Incentives

In implementing the above ideas, at least one thing will be essentially required and this is quality governance. It implies adequate i) transparency ii) accountability iii) responsiveness iv) decentralization v) participation vi) coordination vii) authority and control viii) Planning and productivity , efficiency and leadership

Source: Overview of Urbanization in Bangladesh by
Nazrul Islam, Chairman, (CUS), Dhaka

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Thank You